



PATH 01

Sell an AI playbook

You already know one job well enough to write it down. A stranger will pay to skip the guessing.

19 minute read · 4,211 words

Who this is for

Someone who can explain a single result — a week of content, a client intake, a job application pack — better than a blank chat window.

Time to first

7–21 days if you already know the job

Tools

First sale

A \$19–\$47 download bought by a person who is not you.

Cash window

\$19–\$47 first offer

Leave this alone

Google Docs or Word, Stripe Payment Link or Stan Store, one simple page, a second email to test-buy.

A 200-page 'everything AI' book, fifteen products, or waiting for a course platform.

What this actually is

A job, written down

A playbook is not a memoir about AI. It is a job, written so a tired person can finish it without inventing the steps. The buyer is not shopping for inspiration. They are shopping for a sequence they can run this week.

Narrow beats free

The products that sell in this category are narrow. "How to use ChatGPT" sits in a pile of free posts. "A 10-day content system for a one-person landscaping company" is a product. The more specific the job, the less you compete with free generic advice.

Draft with AI. Ship the rewrite.

You are allowed to use AI to draft. You are not allowed to ship the draft. The money is in the rewrite: your examples, your order of operations, your "do this next" at the end of every chapter. If a chapter does not end with a next action, it is an essay. Cut it or finish it. Read a chapter to someone who does the job. If they ask "so what do I do?" rewrite it. If they say "I can do that tonight," keep it.

Who this is for — and who should skip it

This fits you if

This path fits if you have done a job more than three times and can name what went wrong the first time. That scar tissue is the product. People pay for the mistakes you already made.

You do not need a following. You need one finished result you can explain in plain English: a week of content, a client intake, a job application pack, a month-end close.

Skip this path if

Skip this path if you have never finished a result for anyone, including yourself. Write the playbook after you have a result, not as a way to avoid getting one. If you need cash this week, use a service path first (Productized AI service or Local businesses + AI), then turn the notes into this playbook.

The honest middle

If you have done the job twice and the third time is this week, capture that run as you do it. The playbook is the notes, cleaned. You are not waiting to become an expert. You are waiting to have a sequence you would hand a tired friend.

The offer, named in one sentence

Fill this before you outline

Write this sentence before you outline: "I help [specific person] get [named result] in [time] using [named tools], even if [honest objection]." If you cannot fill the brackets, you do not have an offer yet.

Specific person is a job plus a constraint. Named result is a file or a week of work, not a feeling. Time is days or hours. Named tools are what they already have. Honest objection is why they have not done it.

Sentences that work

I help one-person landscapers get 10 Google-ready posts in 10 days using ChatGPT and photos they already have, even if they hate writing and only have 20 minutes at night.

I help solo accountants close the month in Claude with a checklist they can rerun, even if their books are messy.

I help realtors write listing descriptions that do not sound like brochures, in one sitting, using the MLS notes they already typed.

Price the result, not the page count. First playbooks sell at \$19-\$47. Raise to \$67-\$97 when the file has templates, scripts, and a 14-day plan. Do not start at \$297. You have no proof yet.

One sentence, one product

If you need "and" to name the result, you have two products. Split them. Sell the one you can finish this week.

What "done" looks like

The bar for the file

The playbook is done when a stranger can finish chapter one without you in the room. That is the bar. Everything else is decoration.

Done also means: 8-15 chapters, each titled as a verb plus an object, each ending with one next action. A cover that states the job. Page numbers. Your email on the last page for questions you actually want. A template or prompt they can copy.

The bar for the checkout

One product, one price, one file. A Stripe Payment Link or Stan page whose title matches the one-sentence offer. You have bought it yourself from a second email, on a different browser, and the file arrived and opened.

The bar for the first week

Ten personal messages sent, at least one person who is not you owning the file, and a note of what they used. That note becomes the next post. If nobody has the file yet, send the next three messages before you rewrite the cover.

Pricing that holds

Start where proof is

\$19 is a coffee-and-a-tip price. People will try it if the job is named. \$29 is the default first playbook if you include a template or a prompt block. \$47 is fair when there is a 10- or 14-day plan plus scripts. Do not hide the price behind "DM me." Put it on the page. Pick \$29 or \$47 and sit there until a stranger has bought.

When to raise

Raise after a stranger sale and a sentence from them about what they used. Then add the missing template or a 14-day calendar and move to \$67-\$97. Raise because the file does more, not because you got bored of \$29. Do not add five bonuses to justify a jump. Add one working file.

What not to do

Do not start at \$297. You have no proof yet. Do not do \$9 "to get traction." You will attract collectors, not operators. Do not price by word count. A tight 18-page job at \$29 outsells an 80-page tour of your opinions.

Refunds: offer them, no speech. "If it is not useful, email me and I will refund." You will refund almost nobody if the first chapter works.

The first 72 hours

Hours 1-3: pick and name

Pick the buyer and the result. Write the one-sentence offer. If you have two ideas, pick the one you can finish without research you have not done. Put the sentence at the top of a Google Doc. Do not survey Twitter. Do not build a waitlist. One buyer, one result, one sentence.

Hours 4-8: outline like a tired person

Outline 8-15 chapters. Each chapter title is a verb plus an object: "Write the three hooks," "Set the checkout," "Send the ten messages." Put a next action under each. First chapter: what "done" looks like. Last chapter: what they do next week. Middle chapters are the work.

Paste this if you want a starting outline, then rewrite every title in your voice:

You are outlining a paid playbook, not a blog. Buyer: [person]. Result they can finish: [result]. Time: [days]. Tools they already have: [tools]. Honest objection: [objection]. Give me 12 chapter titles as verb + object. Under each, one next action a tired person can do in 20 minutes. No hype. No "mindset" chapters.

Day 2: ugly draft, then human

Draft ugly. Use AI for a first pass if you want, then rewrite every paragraph in the voice you would use to a friend at a kitchen table. Cut hype. Keep the steps. Read a page out loud. If you would not say it, delete it. Do not format. Do not design a cover. Words first.

Day 3: checkout, self-buy, ten asks

Make the checkout. One product, one price, one file. Buy it yourself from a second email. If the download fails, nothing else matters. Then send ten messages to people who already know you. That is the whole 72 hours.

One buyer, one result, one sentence

8-15 chapters that each end with a next action

Ugly complete draft, then a human rewrite

Working checkout, self-purchase, ten asks

The path, step by step

Steps 1-4: name, gather, outline, draft

Step 1. Name the job on a sticky note. If it takes more than one line, it is two products. Split it. Write the sticky note in the buyer's words, not yours.

Step 2. Collect the raw material you already have: old emails, checklists, prompts that worked, screenshots of a finished result. Dump it into the same Doc under Raw. You will mine it, not show it.

Step 3. Outline for a reader who is tired. First chapter: what "done" looks like. Last chapter: what they do next week. Middle chapters are the work. If a chapter is "Why AI matters," delete it. They already bought.

Step 4. Draft. Do not format yet. Do not design a cover. Words first. Leave holes marked HOLE rather than stopping to research a tool you do not use.

Steps 5-8: voice, files, PDF, checkout

Step 5. Rewrite for voice. Read a page out loud. If you would not say it, delete it. Keep one example per chapter from real work.

Step 6. Add the working files: a template, a prompt block, a checklist. Buyers pay more when they can copy, not just read. Put the checklist on its own page at the back so they can print it.

Step 7. Export a clean PDF. Number the chapters. Put your email on the last page. Filename: something a tired person can find later, like landscaper-10-day-content-playbook.pdf.

Step 8. Checkout. Stripe Payment Link or Stan. Title matches the one-sentence offer. Description is five lines: who, result, time, what is in the file, price.

Steps 9-12: test, ask, learn, then stop

Step 9. Test-buy. Different browser, different email. Confirm the file arrives and opens on a phone.

Step 10. Ten personal messages. Not a broadcast. "I wrote this for [job]. \$19. If it is useful: [link]. If not, ignore."

Step 11. After the first stranger sale, ask what they used. That sentence becomes your next ten posts. "Which chapter did you actually do?" is better than "Did you like it?"

Step 12. Only then add a second product or a \$9 membership. Not before.

A worked example

Dana, one-person landscaping companies, \$29

Dana already writes a few Google posts for her own company when she remembers. She is not a "content person." She is a person who got tired of a blank chat window every Sunday night. She writes a playbook called "10 days of Google-ready posts for a one-person landscaping company." Price: \$29. File: one PDF plus a one-page caption template.

Her one sentence: "I help one-person landscapers get 10 Google-ready posts in 10 days using ChatGPT and job photos they already have, even if they hate writing and only have 20 minutes at night."

What she put in the file

Twelve chapters, each with a next action:

What done looks like — 10 posts scheduled, each with a photo, a caption, and a phone-number line.

Pull 10 photos off your phone from jobs you finished this month.

Pick three post types only: before/after, this-week offer, FAQ.

Write the three hooks you will reuse.

Turn one finished job into a before/after caption.

Write the "this week" offer without sounding cheap.

Write the FAQ post that answers "why does this cost that?"

Paste the batch prompt and generate the other seven captions.

Put the phone number in the last line of every post. Same line, every time.

The 10-day calendar (which post, which photo, which morning).

What to do when nobody comments (you still posted; call three old clients).

What you do next week (repeat the same three types; do not invent a fourth).

She included one prompt they paste with a photo description and a price, and a caption template with blanks. She did not include a module on personal branding.

How she sold the first copies

Day 3 she made a Stripe Payment Link titled the same as the sentence. She bought it from her other Gmail. The PDF opened on her phone. Then she sent ten texts: owners she had swapped trailers with, people from a local Facebook group she already helps, her cousin who runs a lawn crew, and old clients who ask how she "does the posting."

The text: "I put a short playbook up for one-person landscaping companies that need 10 Google posts. One file, \$29, instant download. If that is useful: [link]. If not, no need to reply."

Two people she knew bought on day 3. A stranger bought on day 11 after she posted one before/after from her own yard with the last line "I wrote the 10-day sequence I use. \$29. Link in bio." She asked the stranger which chapter they used. They said chapter 5, the before/after caption. That became her next five posts. She did not write book two.

Copy you can actually send

DM (text or email)

I put a short playbook live for [job]. One file, \$19, instant download. If that is useful: [link]. If not, no need to reply.

Post

Blank chat is expensive. I wrote the sequence I actually use for [result]. \$19. Link in bio.

Or, with a photo of the finished job, not the PDF cover:

This is 10 days of posts for a one-person [trade], written so you can do it after dinner. \$29. Not another AI dump.

Listing title and body

Title: [Job] in [time] — a playbook for [person], not another AI dump.

Body, five lines:

Who it is for: [person].

What they finish: [result] in [time].

What they get: a PDF with [N] chapters, a paste-ready prompt, and a checklist.

What they need: [named tools], no extra subscriptions.

Price: \$29. Instant download. Email me if it is not useful and I will refund.

Email to people who already know you

Subject: the [job] sequence, written down

I got tired of explaining this in pieces, so I wrote a short playbook. It is the order I actually use for [result], including the prompt and the checklist. \$19, one file.

If you want it: [link].

If you do not, delete this. I will not follow up.

Reply to an objection

"I can just ask ChatGPT."

You can. The playbook is the order, the examples from [job], and the next action at the end of each chapter so you do not stall at a blank window. If you already have a sequence you like, you do not need this. If you keep starting over, \$19 is cheaper than another Sunday night.

"I do not have time to read a book."

It is [N] short chapters. Chapter one is what done looks like. Chapter two is a 20-minute task. If you cannot do chapter two this week, wait.

Week-by-week if you have a job

Week 1: outline and ugly draft

No public launch. Two evenings. Evening one: sticky note, one sentence, outline of 8-15 chapters with next actions. Evening two: ugly draft of the whole thing, holes marked HOLE. Do not open

Canva. Finish the words. If you only have 45 minutes a night, do three chapters a night for four nights.

Week 2: rewrite, templates, checkout, ten asks

Rewrite out loud. Add one template and one prompt block. Export the PDF. Set Stripe or Stan. Test-buy from a second email on your phone. Send ten personal messages. First sale is allowed to be someone you know. Do not add a second product this week.

Week 3: teach one chapter, three times

Three posts or emails that teach one chapter. Soft link. Example: post the before/after caption formula. End with "I wrote the rest of the 10-day sequence. Link in bio." If you are not public, send three more personal messages instead of posts.

Week 4: fix, do not expand

Fix whatever the first buyers tripped on. A broken download. A prompt that needed one extra line. A chapter that assumed they had a desktop. Do not write book two. If nobody bought, send ten new asks to people who do the job, then look at the title. The title is usually the problem, not the prose.

Quality bar

Voice

Kitchen table, not conference stage. Short sentences. Named tools. Named times. If a paragraph could run in a motivational clip, cut it. Read the first page to someone who does the job. "I could do that" means you passed.

Structure

Every chapter: one point, one example, one next action. Put the working files where they can steal them — a box, a back page, a second PDF in the zip. Number the chapters. Use the same words in the title, the checkout, and the first paragraph.

Proof inside the file

One real example per chapter beats five generic screenshots. Blur names. Keep the texture: the actual price, the actual photo description, the bad first draft and the good second.

Metrics that matter (and vanity numbers to ignore)

Count these

Checkout works: self-purchase from a second email, file opens on a phone.

Messages sent: ten in the first 72 hours, then ten more if nobody bought.

Sales from people who are not you. One stranger sale is the real start.

"Which chapter did you use?" answers. That sentence is your next post.

Refunds. If you get more than one in the first ten sales, chapter one is unclear or the title oversold.

Ignore these

Landing page visits with no checkout. Follower counts. Cover polish. Word count. A playbook with 12 visitors and three sales is healthy. A playbook with 2,000 visitors and zero sales has a broken offer or a broken title.

A simple weekly log

One line a week: date, messages sent, sales, refunds, one buyer sentence.

Objections you will hear

"I can get this free from ChatGPT."

Plain answer: they can get a draft. They cannot get your order of operations, your examples from this job, and a next action at the end of every chapter. If they already have that sequence, they should not buy. If they keep staring at a blank window, \$19 is the sequence.

"I do not know if I am qualified to write this."

If you have done the job three times and can name what went wrong the first time, you are qualified for a \$19-\$47 playbook. You are not applying to teach a university course. You are handing a tired person the notes you wish you had.

"Nobody will pay for a PDF."

People pay for PDFs every day when the job is named and the checkout is simple. Name the person, the result, and the time. Put the price on the page. Ask ten people.

"I need a course platform / a big list / a funnel."

You need Google Docs, a Payment Link, and ten messages. A course platform is how people delay chapter one. After a stranger has bought, you can put the same file on a nicer page. Not before.

"What if they want a refund?"

You refund them. One sentence. Then you ask what they expected. If two people say the same thing, you fix that chapter. Refunds are cheaper than a reputation for arguing.

How this feeds other paths

Products that grow out of the same notes

The playbook is often the first product because it is the sequence in your head, written down. The same notes become Niche prompt stacks (the prompt blocks, sold on their own), Ship a Claude or ChatGPT skill pack (the instructions, installed so they never paste again), and AI templates and SOPs (the checklist as a filled file).

Do not split them until the playbook has a stranger sale. If they say "can I just have the prompt," that is a prompt stack. If they say "I want this inside Claude," that is a skill pack.

Distribution that uses the same chapters

AI-assisted short-form: each chapter is a 20-second video. Same offer at the end. A weekly AI letter: one chapter taught, one link to the file. Your front door: a diagnostic that tells them which chapter they need, then the playbook.

Services and later products

Local businesses + AI and Productized AI service are how you get paid while the playbook is still a draft — do the job once for a nearby owner, then write what you did. A small AI membership comes after, when you have updates worth a monthly. Do not open all of those doors this month. Finish the playbook.

Mistakes that kill this path

The usual deaths

Writing for "entrepreneurs." That is not a buyer. Writing 80 pages of theory. Shipping a ChatGPT paste. Hiding the price. Launching with five bonuses and no core file. Waiting until it feels ready. Naming it "The AI Playbook" with no job in the title.

The quieter deaths

Building a course platform before a PDF. Adding a membership so you can delay shipping. Redesigning the cover four times. Putting your whole catalog in the listing. Using someone else's examples from a different trade.

The bar, again

The playbook is ready when a stranger can finish chapter one without you in the room. Ship at that bar. Fix after the first ten asks.

Tools and how you actually use them

Writing

Google Docs or Word. One document. The model you already use is enough for the ugly draft. The rewrite is you. Export PDF. Open it on your phone. If the font is tiny or the prompt boxes break, fix the Doc, export again.

Checkout

Stripe Payment Link or Stan Store. One product. Title = the offer sentence, shortened. After payment, the file. You do not need a full site. A simple page that repeats the five-line listing is enough.

The second email

Create it before you launch. Buy your own product. If the download never arrives, fix that before you send a single ask. This step feels small. It is the whole business on day three.

Ship checklist

Before anyone else sees it

- One-sentence offer with all five brackets filled
- 8-15 chapters, verb + object titles, each ending with a next action
- First chapter is what done looks like; last chapter is next week
- One real example, names blurred; one prompt they can paste; one checklist
- Rewrite read out loud; hype cut
- PDF opens on a phone; email on the last page

Before you send the ten asks

- Checkout title matches the offer; price on the page (\$19-\$47)
- Bought from a second email, different browser; file arrived and opened
- Ten names written down; message copied, link tested
- No second product, no bonus pile

After the first sale

Ask: which chapter did you actually use?

Fix the first trip-up

Do not start book two

FAQ

Do I need a big audience?

No. You need ten people who already know you or do the job, a working checkout, and a file that survives chapter one without you.

How long should it be?

Long enough that a tired person can finish the job, short enough that they will start tonight. Most first playbooks are 12-25 pages including the checklist. If you are at 80 pages, you wrote essays. Cut or split.

Can I use AI to write the whole thing?

You can use it to draft. You cannot ship the draft. The buyer is paying for your order, your examples, and your next actions. A pasted ChatGPT article with a cover is the fastest way to a refund.

What if I do not have screenshots or old emails?

Run the job once this week for yourself or for one person. Capture as you go. If you cannot run the job this week, this is not your path yet. Do a service job, then write.

Stripe or Stan?

Either. Stripe Payment Link is enough if you are comfortable with a raw link. Stan is enough if you want the page and the file in one place. Pick one tonight. Do not compare six platforms.

Should I put it on Etsy or Gumroad too?

Not in week one. Sell where you can send a link to ten people. After a stranger sale, you can add a marketplace if the title matches how people search.

What do I do after ten asks and zero sales?

Ask one of the ten: "Was the job wrong, the price wrong, or the timing wrong?" Then look at the title. Most first misses are a vague title. Rewrite the sentence. Send ten new asks. Do not rewrite the whole PDF yet.

Can I charge \$97 on day one if I include a call?

You can, but you just built a service with a PDF attached. If you want the playbook path, keep the file at \$19-\$47 and do not include your calendar. If you want to get paid this week with your time, use Productized AI service and come back.

When do I write the second playbook?

After a stranger has bought the first, told you what they used, and you have fixed the trip-ups. Then only if they ask for the next job.

Is a playbook the same as a prompt pack?

No. A playbook is the sequence, with prompts inside it. A prompt stack is the prompts, with a one-page SOP for which to use when. Dana wrote a playbook because landscapers needed the 10-day order, not 200 clever lines.